



Purnima: Building Infrastructure

The devastating earthquake of 2015 cost thousands of lives and damaged infrastructure and livelihood in Nepal. As part of the recovery effort, Mott MacDonald has been managing the UK aid support to the Government of Nepal for building back better and supporting the recovery of livelihoods. The Purnima Programme covers four of the most affected districts of Gorkha, Dhading, Nuwakot and Rasuwa through four components: strengthening local government, direct reconstruction of the rural infrastructure, private sector development, and leave no one behind.

A review of damaged rural infrastructure post-earthquake confirmed that water supply was the first overall priority for reconstruction by Purnima, followed by trails, trail bridges and schools. Purnima therefore focused on recovery and reconstruction of drinking water supply systems, trails and trail bridges in the first two years of the program. Schemes were prioritized and selected through a rigorous planning process and assessment involving stakeholders from district, palika and community level. Purnima started construction of school building from the third year and is planning on reconstruction of other types of infrastructure prioritized locally through an inclusive planning process at the palika level.

Water Supply: A large need for water supply was identified, to meet immediate needs for house reconstruction, for re-instating the earthquake damaged water systems and for long term domestic use. Purnima developed a programme for water supply reconstruction in the four districts and adjacent areas of three more districts (Lalitpur, Makawanpur and Lamjung), reaching a total of 227,977 people to date.

Foot trails and trail bridges: The rapid expansion in the rural road network has created a risk that trails may soon be rendered unnecessary, and thus Purnima proceeded cautiously. However, a significant need for trails in the northern and remote areas were identified. A total of 356.7 km of trails, in remote areas without road access have been completed. Seven trail bridges of average 60m length have been prioritized and constructed.

Schools: A small programme for reconstruction of primary and basic schools in remote areas is designed, and implementation is underway.

Purnima is developing improved systems for design and quality assurance, and is proposing and introducing measures for sustainable

management of new or reconstructed infrastructure, with well-defined responsibilities for the beneficiary community (in Users' Groups) and local government

The rural infrastructure work of Purnima is implemented by various partners. United Nations World Food Program is leading the construction of foot trails. Trail bridges are being built with technical assistance from the Trail Bridge Support Unit/Helvetas Swiss Inter-cooperation Nepal with different local partners at district level. For water supply reconstruction and recovery, Purnima has partnered with Oxfam and CARE Consortium (which includes Save the Children and DCA). Both Oxfam and CARE consortium work with various district level partners. Similarly, for the school construction, Purnima is working with SAPPROS Nepal with technical supervision from GEOCE.

Purnima's COVID-19 response and recovery

As a post-disaster programme, Purnima was well placed to pivot quickly to initiate new pandemic relief activities while continuing existing post-earthquake recovery ones. Purnima's COVID-19 response included provision of water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) services and facilities in quarantines and isolation centres designated by the local government, and health institutions. The activities covered provision of: touchless handwashing stations, extension of water systems for drinking, supply of toilet cleaning materials, construction of bathrooms and toilets, and distribution of hygiene kits to the .

Purnima partnered with BBC Media Action and district-based radio stations to deliver lifesaving health messages through a behavior change communication programme designed to raise awareness among the public of COVID-19 risks and appropriate control measures including hygiene and sanitation related themes.

Key achievements

Access to safe drinking water at doorsteps

450

L Water schemes constructed

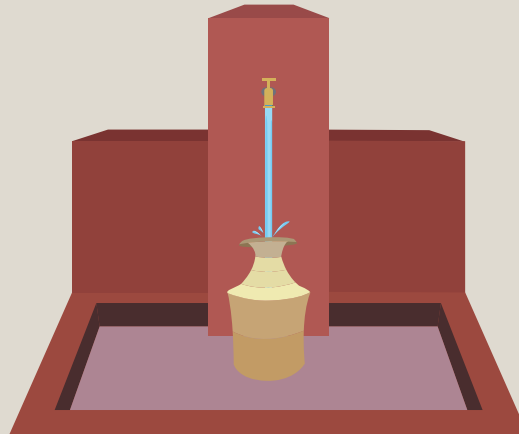
18,697

L Tap stands at individual houses

227,977

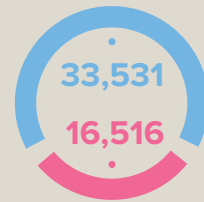
Beneficiary population:

 116,268  111,709

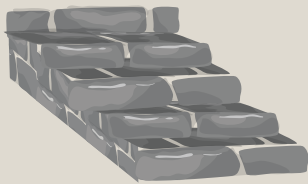


50,047

person days employment generation to local community people
(during COVID-19 lockdown period)



Rural accessibility

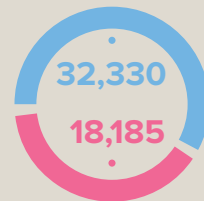


356.7 kms of foot trails
benefiting **19,791** population

15,515
person days employment generation to local community people for trails only
(during COVID-19 lockdown period)



7 bridges (474 meters)
benefiting **24,100** population



Access to education

5 schools with 37 classrooms
(Construction ongoing)

649

expected beneficiary students



COVID-19 response and recovery



140 health institutions provided with handwashing stations

83 quarantine centres provides with WASH facilities*



114

Radio Milijuli programmes with lifesaving messages broadcasted throughout the country

*Including touchless handwashing stations, water system extensions for drinking, bathing and toilets water, toilets, bathrooms, waste management systems, hygiene kits, toilet cleaning materials, hygiene awareness messages and disinfection of surfaces.

Data as of october 2021

For more information :

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